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“CHARISM” AND “CHARISMATIC”

**Historical Theological Reflection
on the Necessity of Appropriate Terminology
for Understanding the Question of the
Co-Essentiality of the Charismatic Dimension of the Church**

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INTRODUCTION

At the Christmas day last year, I had the opportunity to sit at a friendly dinner in the small flat of the bishop of my diocese, chatting about our joys and concerns both in our own lives and in pastoral ministry. In connection with my studies and with the topic of my intended thesis on the spirituality of collaborative ministry, I mentioned I had discovered some interesting texts by the pope speaking about the “co-essentiality” of the “institutional and charismatic dimensions” of the Church.¹ Although the bishop was already a little bit weary, this remark made him sit up.

He started to describe, how it had been like when he had been attending the World Congress of Ecclesial Movements in Rome at Pentecost '98 where these texts I mentioned had had their origin. Then he explained to me, that the pope had actually read two similar speeches during those days. In the first one, he spoke about “co-essentiality” of the two dimensions. Two days later, however, he used “*quasi* co-essential.” The bishop explained it in the way that, after the first speech, Cardinal Ratzinger had raised some objections against the expression “co-essential.” Therefore, according to my bishop, in the following speech the pope had softened it adding “*quasi*.” Before I left, the bishop returned to this topic once again saying: “You know, it is very important, the *charismatic* dimension of the Church. It is, actually, the *Marian* dimension, and this is even more important than the *Petrine*.”

Whether the story with Cardinal Ratzinger arguing with the pope is true, I do not know. But the “*quasi*” is there. Since that Christmas dinner, it has made me wonder how this whole area of co-essentiality of the charismatic and institutional dimensions and the whole business with Maria, Peter and John should be properly understood. In addition, I became more and more aware of the importance of this topic for my

intended thesis. Therefore, I finally decided to grasp the nettle and to delve into it by writing this essay.

Of course, it is not possible to cover all the relevant issues. Therefore, I decided to focus primarily on the problem of terminology and the various concepts of the relationship between the charismatic and institutional dimensions of the Church in background. Therefore, in the *first part* of the essay, I will deal with the complicated history of the term “charism.” My privileged guides will be two outstanding scholars in the area of New Testament exegesis and theology, Jesuits Norbert Baumert and Albert Vanhoye.² For the most recent period, I will then draw on other authors as well.³ In the *second part*, I will reproduce and shortly comment an interesting and, in my opinion, important suggestion made by Norbert Baumert in order to clear up the confusion still prevailing in some of the theological and most of the practical approaches to this topic. Finally, I will draw at least some of my own summarising *conclusions* based on the collected material and on the process of working on this essay.

1. HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENTS OF THE TERM CHARISM

According to Baumert, the largest part of the problems in today’s theology of charisms has been caused by confusing “meaning” and “reference”⁴ of some of the central words used in the Scriptures as well as in today’s theology. If this confusion is not recognised and named, the newer meanings of such a word will be necessarily read back into the original texts which, used again for current reflections, will the situation muddle up even more. Exactly this is the case of the word “charism.” In order to disentangle the muddle, I will at least indicate the most important of the complicated developments in the meaning of this word in various historical periods. Coming nearer to our time, I will then connect these findings with some of the topical issues, in order to see the developments at least in some of their theological and pastoral contexts.

1.1 THE WORD *CHARISMA* IN THE GREEK SPEAKING AREA

In Koine, the word “*charisma*” meant simply a “gracious gift” or “present” (i.e. something good which is given gratis on the basis of a free favour).⁵

In Paul’s letters⁶ and in the writings of the Early Fathers,⁷ only two other specifications have joined to this basic meaning:⁸ (something good) “given by God,” in the “creation order” (Did 1,5; 1 Clem 38,1) or the “Old Testament order” (Rom 11:29), but first of all in the “salvation order of the New Testament.” Both at Paul and at the Early Fathers, “*charisma*” usually means specific (objective) contents (e.g. a prophesy as a specific event), not a (subjective) capability (e.g. gift of prophesying as an ability of somebody). In addition, the popular meaning of *charisma* as a “grace for the good of others” is not confirmed as Pauline either.⁹ Finally, “Paul never uses *charisma* in opposition to institution ... The New Testament writings as a whole tend rather to confirm that the Church possesses an institutional structure that is also charismatic, although it does not hold a monopoly on charisms.”¹⁰

In the period from Origen to John Damascene,¹¹ other connotations occasionally join to the basic meaning: “by (God) the Holy Spirit,” “always individually given” (= particular) “capability” (subjective ability). However, the universal meaning (God’s generous gift) is still simultaneously in use.¹² The subjective dimension (“capability,” “ability”) will be deeper rooted in the concept of *charisma* only at the end of this period, at John Damascene (d. ca. 749).

1.2 THE LOAN *CHARISMA* IN LATIN UP TO 17TH CENTURY

In most cases, Vulgate¹³ translates *charisma* as *gratia*,¹⁴ rarely by *donum*¹⁵ or *donatio*.¹⁶ Only the translation of 1 Cor 12:31 uses the loan *charisma*.¹⁷ Thus Latin writers¹⁸ use *charisma* as a loan especially for the gifts of the Spirit listed in 1 Cor 12 (and Jes 11:2; sic!). But they use it as well for naming all possible gifts of the Holy Spirit, but also offices and

virtues, not only (subjective) “abilities,” but also (objective) “contents.” Hence, the Latinists did not yet create from this loan any technical term and did not add any new meanings to the Greek concept of the word.

The same holds true for Thomas Aquinas¹⁹ who uses *charisma* for quotations of 1 Cor 12:31 and of the Fathers in the same wide meaning. While he (in connection with 1 Cor 12:4) develops the technical term “*gratia gratis data*,”²⁰ he does not connect it in any way with the loan *charisma*.²¹

The humanists²² eliminated the loan *charisma* and corrected Vulgate using *donum* for translating 1 Cor 12:31 and all other occurrences of *charisma* (instead of *gratia*). For them, *donum*, however, does not have any undertow of “ability” nor is identical with *gratia gratis data*. The meaning of *donum* is now actually the same as the original meaning of *charisma*: a “present.”

1.3 TOWARDS THE TECHNICAL TERM *CHARISMA*

At the beginning of the 17th century,²³ some indications of the development of re-introducing the loan *charisma* back into Latin can be already observed. In addition, at that time the term was identified with the Thomas’ concept of *gratia gratis data* for the first time (by Estius). Hence, the term acquired the meaning of “by (God) the Holy Spirit,” “always individually given” (= particular) “capability” (subjective ability), which is “granted gratis” (i.e. not for one’s own salvation necessary) “for service on the salvation of the other.” Thus, neither the Holy Spirit itself, nor forgiveness and sacraments were included any more, because the term was now neither applicable for *gratia increata* nor for *gratia sanctificans*. Neither gifts primarily oriented towards the relationship of the individual to God²⁴ were included. On the other hand, ordination was seen as a *gratia gratis data*, hence as a *charisma*.

Only in the 19th century,²⁵ ordination (office) and ordinary unexceptional gifts were finally excluded from the meaning of the term *charisma* as well, and the term was narrowed to “extraordinary gifts, miracles,” which are “dynamic, event-like,” “directly, without any mediation, given by the Spirit” (in opposition to the historically mediated, permanent institutional offices, sacraments and other structures).²⁶

The term was further specified as “natural ability sized by God’s grace,”²⁷ which opened the way for its sociological usurpation²⁸ (Weber’s “charismatic” type of leadership, besides “traditional” and “legal” ones) and for emphasising that “charism is a performance within a (human or ecclesial) community which arises spontaneously, from free inspiration.” In addition, from that time, a pejorative, flattened meaning of something unpredictable, unsystematic or disordered usually joins.

1.4 THE THEOLOGICAL TERM *CHARISMA* BEFORE VATICAN II

Pius XII’s *Mystici corporis* (1943)²⁹ uses the term *charisma* partly in the broad meaning of the Fathers and of the Middle Ages,³⁰ partly points in the direction of a kind of restriction in the meaning of the term.³¹ According to *Mystici corporis*, the “ordered or ‘organic’ structure of the body of the Church” neither contains “only hierarchical elements,” nor is composed “only of charismatics”.³² It follows that in this document, the usage of the term *charisma* is not univocal and mirrors its complex historical development.

In the Protestant exegesis around the half of the century, most scholars followed Grau’s (1946)³³ definition of charisms as “*durch die unverdiente Gnade Gottes vom Heiligen Geist geschenkte Möglichkeiten christlichen Handelns, das sich in Dienstleistungen und Ämtern zur Aufbaumung der Gemeinde konkretisiert*,”³⁴ which was nevertheless based on a rather distorted methodology of his approach. However, this definition had huge influence on many later authors dealing with the problematic of charisms.³⁵

In the Catholic theology,³⁶ von Balthasar speaks of “*hierarchisch-amtlichen*” (not identical with the sacramental office) und “*übrigen, den Laien zukommenden*” charisms.³⁷ Rahner (1958),³⁸ distinguishing charisms from the office, from the sacraments and (partly) from the virtues, sees in them a “*Wesenzug der Kirche*.”³⁹ He distinguishes “*amtliche Charismen*,” which are ordered to the sacramental offices (in the sense of their appropriation or execution), and “*nichtinstitutionelle Charismen*,” which “*in jedem Gerechtfertigten keimhaft sind*.”⁴⁰ Finally, Semmelroth emphasises that the activity of the Spirit in the “*freien charismatischen Gaben*” and in the “*hierarchisch strukturierten Kirche*” must be “*nicht geteneinander ausspielen*,” because both are mutually ordered to each other in a fruitful tension. The “*charismatische Wirken*,” which also “*plötzlich hereinbrechen*” can, “*dient der Sinnerfüllung des Institutionellen*.”⁴¹

However, quite different a concept of the term charism and of the relationship between charism and office, which gained widespread influence both before and after the Council, was presented by Käsemann (1960).⁴² For him, a charism (which in his opinion possesses a technical meaning in Pauline theology) is “*der spezifische Anteil des einzelnen an der Herrschaft und Herrlichkeit Christi*,” which “*sich in einem spezifischen Dienst und einer spezifischen Berufung erweist*.” The term describes the “*Wesen und Aufgabe aller kirchlichen Dienste und Funktionen theologisch präzise und umfassend*.” “*„Amtsträger“ sind alle Getauften*“ and “*„alle Charismatiker sind als solche zugleich Amtsträger*.”⁴³ However, if subdued to a solid analysis, Käsemann’s positions seem to be rather inconsistent, confusing and ideological, permeated by his underlying intention “of setting charism and institution – with the exception of baptism – in opposition as two incompatible factors, in the dream of a purely ‘charismatic’ Church.”⁴⁴

1.5 THE CONCEPT OF *CHARISMA* IN THE DOCUMENTS OF VATICAN II

Vatican II⁴⁵ uses the word *charisma* (or *charismaticus*) fourteen times.⁴⁶ After a lively debate between the supporters of two different concepts of charisms,⁴⁷ in the final version of LG 12, the word is used for naming “special graces” (gifts in the subjective sense of abilities), that the Spirit distributes “as he wills” (1 Cor 12:11) “among the faithful of every rank.” “These charisms” („*quae charismata*“) can be both “very remarkable” and “more simple and widely diffused.”⁴⁸ “By these gifts he makes them fit and ready to undertake various tasks and offices for the renewal and building up of the Church” (1 Cor 12:7). Thus the Council distinguishes between “hierarchic and charismatic gifts,” which have their origin in the same Spirit (LG 4). Using the Latin word *charisma* in this way, the Council takes back the limitation of the term to miraculous gifts, relativizes the extraordinary character of charisms, and makes a clear distinction between institution and charism while emphasising their common origin in the Holy Spirit and their mutual interdependence (see LG 7; 12; AA 3).⁴⁹

The concept of “abilities” is further specified by “capability, calling, vocation” for an action (see AG 23). These callings or abilities are not permanently at our disposal, in contrast to the word of the Scripture and the sacraments, which God disposed permanently in the Church. However, in spite of their dynamic, event-like character, charisms are still oriented towards concrete institutional embodiment. One of the forms of such embodiment which can be seen as implicitly recognised by Vatican II, is the religious state of life, which is seen as a special “divine gift” of grace (LG 43, see OT 19).⁵⁰

Furthermore, if understood in Vatican II’s directions, charisms are given or offered to every Christian; they are oriented towards and reliant on communication, complementarity, discernment, correction, and life in a community; they are

constitutive for the structure of the Church; they are designated for building up the community. Charisms, seen as revelations of the Spirit, have symbolic (sign-like) and testimonial character (also outside the Church) and they are oriented towards the redemption and salvation of the world (both “inside” and “outside” the Church).⁵¹

1.6 THE DIVERSITY OF POSTCONCILIAR POSITIONS

Influenced by Käsemann,⁵² Hans Küng (1965; similarly Hasenüttl and Boff)⁵³ sees charism as a generous gift, which includes all possible ordinary and diverse phenomena, which are very common and widespread.⁵⁴ It seems that the meaning of the word charism is here watered down and loses any substance.⁵⁵ On the other hand, he simultaneously sees charism as a special grace, as *„der an den einzelnen ergehende Ruf Gottes zu einem bestimmten Dienst in der Gemeinde, der zugleich zu diesem Dienst befähigt.“*⁵⁶

According to Vanhoye, it seems that Küng uses these two concepts in order to „limit the sphere of responsibility of the pastors of the Church as much as possible.“⁵⁷ The broad understanding he uses for emphasising that “the charisms are not reserved to the hierarchy of the Church.” The narrower concept then provides for him the foundations for his thesis of “the charismatic structure of the Church which embraces and goes beyond the structure of its government.” We can understand it in the sense that when each Christian receives (as his or her charism given directly by God) some specific ministry to be performed within the Church, he or she has then thus the right to perform it without any interference from the hierarchy.⁵⁸

In any case, it is quite clear that Küng (and similarly Hasenüttl) at least blends the Pauline concept that everything is a “God’s gift” with the modern technical term of charism. The same can be perhaps said about some writings in the area of liberation theology (under the influence of Boff)⁵⁹ and some approaches to the theology of collaborative ministry⁶⁰ (under the influence of O’Meara).⁶¹

Later after the Council, there has been a growing need for finding new ways of integration of the institutional and charismatic aspects of the Church.⁶² The way forward is usually seen in re-emphasising the balance between charismatic and hierarchic dimensions of the Church indicated in Vatican II documents and the both pneumatological and christological character of both of them (LG 4 and 12; AA 3).⁶³ Trying to correct (or at least re-direct or complement) the line of thought outlined in the previous three paragraphs, many theologians, in various ways, have defended the conciliar understanding of the complementarity of both hierarchical and charismatic aspects of the Church. Based on my small survey,⁶⁴ it is possible to say that the recognition of the co-essentiality of the institutional and charismatic aspects became a theological common ground.⁶⁵ Nevertheless, the continuing confusion in terminology⁶⁶ can be still clearly seen in the writings of many exegetes, theologians and pastoral practitioners,⁶⁷ even in many of the most frequently used dictionaries.⁶⁸

1.7 CHARISMS IN THE CATECHISM OF THE CATHOLIC CHURCH

The important emphasis on Vatican II's concept of charismatic and hierarchical gifts as distinct, unique, mutually interdependent and spiritually "graced" dimensions of the Church is repeated and emphasised both in *Christifideles laici* (1988)⁶⁹ and in the *Catechism of the Catholic Church* (1992).⁷⁰ However, the vital difference between Scriptural and theological terminology is there still not clarified, but rather supported:

On the one hand, the Catechism uses various words ("special graces," "special gifts," "spiritual gifts," diversity of "gifts")⁷¹ for naming the phenomena which today are usually labelled by the technical term "charisms" in the sense of a special gift of the Holy Spirit useful in the life and mission of the Church, although some of these words or terms ("spiritual gifts," "gifts") are many times used in their generic meaning as well. On the other hand, the Catechism uses the loan "*charisma*" in its narrow technical

sense,⁷² but it “defines” it illogically as “favour,” “gracious gift,” benefit,” thus in its original biblical generic sense.⁷³

For our exploration, it is further interesting, that the Catechism deal with charisms also in its section on grace (No. 1996-2005).⁷⁴ Speaking about grace as “a participation in the life of God,” which “introduces us into the intimacy of trinitarian life” (No. 1997), it goes on by emphasising the “supernatural” character of this vocation (No. 1998) and pointing to “sanctifying or deifying grace” as a “gratuitous gift” received in baptism (No. 1999). Using rather traditional terms, the Catechism distinguishes between “habitual grace” (as “the permanent disposition to live and act in keeping with God’s call”) and “actual graces” (“which refer to God’s interventions, whether at the beginning of conversion or in the course of the work of sanctification”) (No. 2000). Furthermore, it distinguishes between “sacramental graces” (which are seen as the “gifts proper to the different sacraments”) and “special graces, also called charisms” (which are “oriented toward sanctifying grace,” “intended for the common good of the Church” and “at the service of charity which builds up the Church”) (No. 2003).⁷⁵

Interestingly, the Catechism includes the “graces of state” (“that accompany the exercise of the responsibilities of the Christian life and of the ministries within the Church”), which are through the term “special graces” identified with “charisms.”⁷⁶ Hence, it seems that, firstly, the Catechism is open to the concept of charisms which is not exclusively narrowed down to the “ministerial” direction, but sees the possibility that a charism can be (primarily) oriented towards “Christian life.”⁷⁷ Secondly, although the distinction between “sacramental graces” and charismatic “special graces” or “charisms” is maintained (No. 2003) and some of the charismatic “graces of state” do not follow the sacramental structure (such as graces proper to religious life), it seems

that the Catechism is open to the concept of charismatic “graces of state” which can in a sense follow the sacramental structure (such as special graces proper to ordination of matrimony).⁷⁸

1.8 CONSECRATED LIFE AND NEW ECCLESIAL MOVEMENTS

Since Vatican II, there has been a recognizable growing tendency of interpreting consecrated life as a part of the “charismatic dimension” or “charismatic structure” of the Church.⁷⁹ Consecrated life is often seen as the primary space where this “charismatic dimension” has been lived in the Church or as the “clearest example of a ‘charismatic structure’ within the church” and as a good example of the necessity “to appreciate the existence of other sociological structures alongside that of the hierarchy,” which “are determined by the charisms which the Holy Spirit, in perfect freedom, distributes among the People of God.”⁸⁰

The internal re-orientation of consecrated life from a kind of ‘exclusive club of holiness’ to a more inclusive understanding as a ‘special case’ of the universal call to holiness (which was initiated by the text of Vatican II)⁸¹ has been importantly enriched by the grow and maturing of many of the ‘new ecclesial movements’⁸² in the last few decades.⁸³ Thus both of these developments are by many theologians seen as an important *locus theologicus* for theological reflection on the many questions connected with the issue of “institution and charism,” and for our understanding of charisms and ecclesiology in general.⁸⁴

Most of the newer literature to this theme comment or elaborate the John Paul II’s comments on the “co-essentiality” of the “institutional and charismatic aspects” or “dimensions” in the “Church constitution”⁸⁵ mentioned in the introduction. While wanting to be faithful to the teaching of Vatican II, some commentators approach this topic from the perspective of Balthasarian theology of the so-called “Marian,”

“Johannine” and “Petrine” dimensions of the Church.⁸⁶ However, discerning between the “objective charism” (the Word and Sacraments) and the “subjective charism” (charismatic gifts) given by the same Holy Spirit to the Church,⁸⁷ they, unfortunately, even further confuse the terminology.⁸⁸ Others prefer as their framework the concept of apostolic succession from its historical perspective in its universal and local dimensions.⁸⁹ Even others choose as their point of departure the ecclesiology of communion, while combining it with the historical and Balthasarian perspectives as well.⁹⁰ Most of these commentators, however (the same as most of today’s ecclesiologists), emphasise the importance of the trinitarian understanding of the Church and its dimensions.⁹¹

Finally, this slowly emerging new ecclesiological synthesis⁹² have to be seen on the background of some of the new emphases surfacing in the area of theological anthropology which, after its rediscovery of the important personal and social dimensions, seems to be now rediscovering some new emphases (countercultural, ecclesial, trinitarian, ecological and cosmic).⁹³

2. TOWARDS A THEOLOGICAL SYNTHESIS AND TERMINOLOGY

Although today, some of the important dictionaries or ecclesiological works have already taken in account the results of the newer exegetical and linguistic explorations,⁹⁴ the acceptance of the two very different concepts of the word “charism” (the Scriptural one and the modern theological one) emerges only slowly. We have already seen, that this clarifying process⁹⁵ has very important consequences for clarifying some of the current issues in today’s both ecclesiology and pastoral ministry. In this section, I will, at first, summarise the main points which Baumert offers as a kind of the synthesis of his historical and linguistic explorations described in the previous part.

This synthesis will then point to a concrete suggestion of a more precise use of the meaning of the term “charisma” and “charismatic” in today’s theology.

2.1 CENTRAL ISSUES IN THE THEOLOGY OF CHARISMS

In this section, I will follow Baumert’s subdivision based on seven questions focused on some of the central issues connected with the theology of charisms.⁹⁶

Who does give charisms? The term charism, as used today, became a central term of pneumatology and is strongly associated with the action of the Holy Spirit understood as the “Pentecost-Spirit” of the New Testament order. In a traditional language, we can speak about “appropriation” to the Holy Spirit. Both Christ and the Spirit are always acting together (see AG 3 and 4), but still in such a way that we can to assign the visibly “constituted” elements⁹⁷ specially to Christ’s incarnation, and the invisible revivifying charismatic gifts, which again and again bring new life into the community, to the Holy Spirit.⁹⁸ Because there cannot be any rivalry between Jesus and the Holy Spirit, there can be no serious rivalry or opposition between the elements constituted by historical Jesus and these vivifying charismatic activities of the Spirit.⁹⁹

What does the Spirit give/cause? Today, a charism, understood as a personal, God-given, graced ability or vocation, is put exclusively on the subjective side of human behaviour. Hence, it is clearly distinct from the word and sacraments, although not so clear from the virtues.¹⁰⁰ Because it is always God’s gift of the New Testament order, it is also distinct from natural abilities or talents. Not all charisms have to be “remarkable,” in fact, many are very “simple and widely diffused” (LG 12), but they are always *grace-based* realities.

To whom does the Spirit give a charism? Charisms, as diverse and always unique “equipment” for Christian life, are given (or offered) to each Christian, “to everyone” (1 Cor 12:11 quoted in LG 12); they are distributed “among the faithful of

every rank” (LG 12). From this perspective, a charisma is distinct from the sanctifying grace and from virtues, because it is “equipment” which is not necessary the same for all the people in general. It is “freely given” by the Spirit “as he wills” (LG 12). Charisms are something universal, as they are given to everybody. They are, however, something particular as well, as everybody is given something different. Therefore, such gifts are mutually interdependent and can be lived out only in mutual communication. Usually, they are given only to Christians, on the basis of their faith and baptism. If not, they are still oriented towards the community of faith.

When does the Spirit give a charism? Charisms (contrary to virtues) are given rather surprisingly (without any possibility to “plan” them), although they not always come all of a sudden (without any preparation for them). They are given not only “to whom” the Spirit wills, but also “when” the Spirit wills. Charisms are not “at our disposal” in the sense that we could “control” them. It is God’s decision, what charisms will be given to an individual person, but also to a specific era, because they are “are fitting and useful for the needs of the Church” (LG 12). Charisms are given during all of the historical periods, although always in different forms and expressions. In this sense, the charismatic dimension belongs necessarily and permanently to the very constitution of the Church.

In what way does the Spirit give charisms? The Spirit, by distributing charisms, acts “freely,” not being “bound” to or “dependent” on any rites, human activities or structures (unlike the sacraments).¹⁰¹ Who “has” a specific charism, he or she “has” it in a way which demands an “exercise” of perpetual dependence on God. Hence, it is not possible to understand sacramental ordination or “office” as a charism in today’s technical meaning. Of course, each “office” and “ministry” in the Church (including ordained ministries) presupposes a charism of personal vocation and

appropriation, and demands perpetual openness for particular charisms, which are necessary for carrying out the specific ministry and which are in a special way “connected” with this ministry.¹⁰² Nevertheless, they are not identical with the office and they still have to be again and again “actualised” in the process of personal openness.¹⁰³ In any case, each charism has to be open for being a part of communicative *communio* of the Church, including the need of a kind of confirmation from the side of the “office.”

To what end does the Spirit give charisms? Every charism, being a part of the Church *communio*, being “embodied” within the Christ’s Body, is always in a way oriented towards building this Body and towards promoting its growth. It is clear that some charisms are primarily oriented to a specific service or ministry. However, not all charisms have to have such a direct “ministerial” orientation. Some can be (primarily) oriented rather towards personal growth or worship.¹⁰⁴ On the other hand, the performance of the more ministerially oriented charisms should be always seen as a special kind of worship as well. Hence, the expression “for service” should not be a part of a definition of the charism.¹⁰⁵ The ultimate end of charisms is not a building of the Church or a community, but the salvation and sanctification of men and women, of which the Church is a “universal sacrament.”

How is it possible to recognise charisms? While charisms (because of their character as a “gifts of grace”) are not to be understood as “natural endowments in the service of the Spirit,” they should be seen as new special graces coming from God, by which the nature is purified, healed, integrated, and simultaneously transcended.¹⁰⁶ Therefore, however, they can be easily (miss)understood as purely natural abilities.¹⁰⁷ Nevertheless, because it is not possible to draw a neat line between the “natural” and the “supernatural,” any criterion based on the concept of “exceeding natural abilities”

is at least questionable. Ultimately, charismatic (and all “grace-based”) phenomena, can be judged only in the light of the same Holy Spirit who is their origin. The core question is, whether a spiritual event is at work in the centre of such a process.¹⁰⁸

2.2 BAUMERT’S SUMMARISING SUGGESTION

This section is a working translation of the suggestion which has been made by Norbert Baumert¹⁰⁹ as a summary of his historical and linguistic explorations, in order to show a possible way of clarifying many of the confusions being mentioned again and again during our historical excursion. The suggestion is based on the conviction of its author that it is not possible to reverse the terminological development and that it is important to base any terminological decision on the foundational options of Vatican II and the basic ecumenical agreements.

The whole salvation order of the New Testament has a foundational “gift-like” character. Within it, we can distinguish two “categories” of God’s “graced gifts”:

- A) Objective salvation-goods [*Objektive Heilsgüter*], which are fundaments or expressions of BEING/LIVING in Christ, such as:
 - a) the new life itself (grace, justification, healing),
 - b) the word (of the Scripture and of the Gospel proclamation),
 - c) the basic sacraments (such as the baptism, Eucharist; not the office),
 - d) the (freely given [*unferfügte*]) signs which are given, how the Spirit wills (such as a specific healing, a specific prophecy, a specific miracle as such, also some specific events, e.g. various guiding inspirations [*Führungen*]). Paul has such contents in his mind in 1 Cor 12; they are not “charisms” in the sense of subjectively accepted gifts [*Be-gabung*].
- B) Subjective salvation-goods [*Subjektive Heilsgüter*], or better: personal ABILITIES [BEFÄHIGUNGEN] for ACTING in Christ, such as:
 - a) abilities and ways of behaving which are being offered to every person, who are thus also challenged to accept and use them (such as theological virtues, the “seven gifts”),
 - b) always personally given abilities [*je individuelle Befähigungen*] which are
 - either “bound” [*gebunden* (= *verfügt*)] to historical handing over (“*traditio*”) (e.g. Church commission, office/ordination etc.),
 - or given freely (“unbound”), in a dynamic [*ereignishaft*] and immediate way, by the Holy Spirit: CHARISMS.

All items, besides the ones in the section “b□,” should not be labelled by the loan “charism,” in spite of its different usage in the Scriptures and the Greek Fathers.¹¹⁰ This should be respected in translations as well.

The current theological term “charism” means:

A freely given, gratuitous (from one's own inducement),
event-like (immediate, unbound)
ability [*Befähigung*] (subjectively given and accepted capability)
for acting (feasible only in freedom)
in the communion (communication and spiritual discernment)
of Christian faithful (the Church),
which belongs to the salvation order of the NT (new creation, grace),
is oriented towards salvation
(transforming redemption in Christ)
in the Church (in, through, or oriented towards the Body of Christ)
and in the world (through the Church oriented towards everything unsaved in the 'world'),
extra (not necessarily, in addition),
always personally (individually, diversely, variously, multifariously)
and graciously given (practicable only in a receptive attitude)
by God, the Holy Spirit,
to every Christian.

This is to be excluded from its meaning:

× on the basis of a right, demand, title, claim, merit etc.
× bound on a human “*traditio*”
× objective “presents,” contents, events themselves
× for being, living or having in Christ
× isolated immediacy with God, asserting oneself without any dialog
× understandable and verifiable without Christian faith
× creation order, natural endowments
× purely human welfare, social or political values as the ultimate end
× salvation-individualism, salvation-egoism
× limited to the Church only, collective salvation-egoism of the Church for its own sake
× belonging to the basic equipment
× given the same to all Christians, such as theological virtues
× possibly evocable by human means, learnable, makeable
× proprium of the Son (“died for us”)
× given only to some “charismatics”

(Unlike the exclusive positions stressed above, the following distinctions should be not a part of the term-definition; therefore, charisms can be:)

- both *simpler* (discreet), and more *remarkable* (“shining,” miraculous)
- both *actual* (always new, surprising), and *habitual* (but also in the case of a permanent charism, it is necessary to accept it always newly, “event-like”)
- both primarily oriented towards the conduct and growth of *one's own spiritual life*, and primarily oriented towards a salvation-service for *the benefit of the other*¹¹

In summary: “‘*Charism*’ is an ability that proceeds from the grace of God, given by God the Holy Spirit, specifically and personally in each case, that is allotted for the life and service in the Church as community of salvation and in the world.”

However, the today's meaning of the *adjective* ‘charismatic’ is *broad*er than the *noun* ‘charism.’ It practically includes all ‘free’ actions of the Spirit which are not bound through the Word, the sacraments and the office. A ‘charismatic’ activity can be also seen in “actual graces” or in bestowment of a special degree of a virtue or one of the “seven gifts.”¹²

In addition, if we use the word ‘*charismatic*’ as a noun,¹¹³ it has a *narrower* application field than charism, not only at Pius XII,¹¹⁴ but also at Vatican II, LG 7.¹¹⁵ The use of the scriptural reference show that the text points to the owners of remarkable abilities; there are besides them (“*etiam*” *charismaticos*) as well some other members. Although it is to discourage such a usage, because the term becomes then again very narrow, it is still necessary to pay attention, what is meant.¹¹⁶

2.3 SOME FURTHER COMMENTS

Although such a categorising could be played down as useless typecasting, my conviction is that it is a necessary tool for meaningful speaking about basic concepts of the Church, spiritual life and pastoral ministry today. Not only the consistent distinction between the (broad) scriptural and the (narrow) theological meaning can help in better understanding the original structures of the Church community, but also a consensus in use of the term in theology and pastoral practice would be helpful for clarifying some of the many misunderstandings in today’s communication and ministry. It seems to me, that the suggested terminological regulations are based not only on a thorough historical linguistic research, but that they also correspond to all the currents of today’s theological discourse.¹¹⁷

If this concept was used in discussions about the problematic of the charismatic dimension of the Church, it would protected us against two extreme interpretations:

On the one hand, it would be not possible to say that “*the* essential (deepest, foundational) structure of the Church is (primarily) charismatic” in the sense that also “apostles” and “teachers” (see 1 Cor 12:28; 1 Cor 3:9-17; Eph 2:20; Gal 2:7-8) are charismatic gifts which do not have any permanent mission (“apostolic authority;” “office”). On the other hand, it would be clear, that the Church has been not constituted only from apostles and teachers, but that the dynamically, freely, personally and often unexpectedly given activities of the Spirit are also essential elements of the Church constitution (see the “prophets” in Eph 2:20).¹¹⁸

From the perspective of salvation history, we can say that at the time of the paschal mystery (Christ's death, Christ's resurrection, and Pentecost), the Holy Spirit has been "charismatically" given and poured out into a "riverbed" as it were of the historical traditions "constituted" by Christ. Therefore, these historically constituted structural elements (the word, the sacraments, the Church as the foundational sacrament including its ordained office) are still simultaneously and continuously the work of the Spirit. At the same time, the "*traditio*" is set up in such a way that it is permanently reliant on the "charismatic rain" or "showers." If the (institutional) "riverbed" would lock itself against these (charismatic) "waters from above," it would soon, at least in a certain degree, get dry. "In this sense, the "charism" is an essential and indispensable element in the Church, but it is not the only activity of the Spirit in the Church."¹¹⁹

CONCLUSIONS

Concluding this essay, I am aware that now, after having collected and, I hope, correctly understood all the material, it would be the best time for starting to relate the collected threads together, to reflect on them, to speculate about different possibilities and various consequences of various options. However, I would be now able only to indicate some of the most important insights I have gain by studying all this material and to suggest some possible directions for further explorations.

Firstly, the original question of this essay (why the pope had shifted from the expression that "the charismatic and institutional *dimensions* are *co-essential* to the divine constitution" to the expression that "the institutional and charismatic *aspects* are *quasi co-essential* to the Church constitution") remains, of course, unanswered. I would have to ask directly him. But in my opinion, if the word "charismatic" is understood in the meaning suggested by Baumert, I do not see any reason for the "*quasi*" expression.

Both of these two elements (aspects, dimensions) are equally necessary to the Church, both of them are equally essential to its divine constitution.¹²⁰ Hence, both of them can and should be rightly seen as fully and equally “co-essential” to the Church constitution.¹²¹ If we wanted to retain Balthasarian symbolic, we could to understand it perhaps in the following way: Mary would symbolise the “foundational” (christological-pneumatological) dimension, embracing both the “hierarchical” (Peter) and the “charismatic” (John) dimensions of the Church.¹²²

Secondly, applying Baumert’s findings, positions and suggestions for the explorations of the topic of the charismatic dimension of the Church has proved to be very fruitful. After studying it in great detail and putting it in conversation with other approaches and Church documents, I am now convinced that this suggestion corresponds to a wider growing consensus among exegetes and theologians and that it points to an important direction. Complemented by other similar approaches in ecclesiology (such as the emphasis on the trinitarian dimension), it could help to deal with some of the difficult issues of today’s theology,¹²³ pastoral practice¹²⁴ and spirituality.¹²⁵

Thirdly, coming personally from the background of Charismatic Renewal and studying this year the long and adventurous story of the various shifts in understandings grace in Church’s teaching and Christian theology, I became intensively aware of the sometimes very real tension between the “incarnational” and “ecclesial” emphases in spirituality.¹²⁶ By studying Duffy’s great overview of the “dynamics of grace,” I was quite surprised and pleased when learning about some of the attempts pointing towards a kind of a new synthesis of the mystical, incarnational, countercultural, creational, ecclesial and trinitarian dimensions of grace. I wonder, whether the concept of “charisma” and “charismatic” promoted in this essay would

not be able to offer a useful framework for the necessary encounter of all of these dimensions both in pastoral practice and in spirituality?¹²⁷ It seems to me that it would be able to provide at least a kind of a sound theoretical framework and, put into practice, to support all of these emphases while inviting them into a more organic unity in diversity.¹²⁸

Finally, I see once again that the next necessary step in the process of some preliminary work on the theological backgrounds of my thesis will have to be studying the many various options influenced by various understanding of the place and character of the sacramental “office,” both in its origins, and in its history and current understandings.¹²⁹ If the charismatic dimension is *co*-essential, I cannot stay at studying only a half of the story. It needs something to be *com*plemented by, in *comm*union, *collaboration* and *comm*on mission. After studying the second half, I will be, finally, perhaps ready to delve into the primary and foundational Marian dimension, and to focus on the central question of my thesis, the question of the spirituality for collaborative ministry.

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NOTES

- ¹ For longer quotations and bibliographical references see footnote n. 85.
- ² Although these two scholars know each other very well, it seems to me that they have come to their conclusions in regard to the terminology of the word "charism" rather independently.
- ³ The principal sources for this essay are the following: N. Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 2 vols. (Würzburg: Echter, 2001); this 2 volumes book is a synthesis of Baumert's linguistic, exegetical and theological work on the topic of charism. For a short English summary of this book, see N. Baumert, "Charism' and 'Spirit-baptism': Presentation of an Analysis," *Norbert Baumert Bibliography* (Homepage Sankt Georgen, www.st-georgen.uni-frankfurt.de/bibliogr/baumert7.htm). One of the key studies which has been included into the 2 volumes book is N. Baumert, "Charisma'- Versuch einer Sprachregelung," *TbPh* 66 (1991) 21-48, which can be found also on the internet: *Norbert Baumert Bibliography* (Homepage Sankt Georgen, <http://www.st-georgen.uni-frankfurt.de/bibliogr/baumert3.htm>). The second author in the background of this study is A. Vanhoye, who develops positions very similar to Baumert's one in A. Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms' after Vatican II," in *Vatican II Assessment and Perspectives: Twenty-five Years After (1962-1987)*, edited by R. Latourelle (New York: Paulist Press, 1988) 1:439-468. Lastly, P. Mullins's article on the most recent developments in the theology of charisms can be seen as interesting example of a position, which, although probably developed independently on Baumert's one (at least, Mullins does not quote Baumert), is still pointing to the same direction: P. Mullins, "The Theology of Charisms: Vatican II and the New Catechism," *Milltown Studies* 33 (1994) 123-162.
- ⁴ The problem is that "language narrows down words to a specific content through frequent use in a certain context (the origin of terms), changes their emphases (e.g. through translations), enriches them with new contents (e.g. because of new developments and experiences), or words receive a new connotation in a new context. These 'natural occurrences' must first be comprehended and described in order to arrive at the intended meaning and to become sure in the use of words." Baumert, "Charism' and 'Spirit-baptism,'" the final paragraph of the introduction; see also Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 226. For more scientific explanation, see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:17-27.
- ⁵ The noun, derived from the verb *charizesthai* (= "to show oneself generous, to present"), is related to *charis* (grace), *eucharistein* (to give thanks), and many other terms. It is formed with the aid of the suffix *-ma*, and expresses the result of the action indicated by the verb; see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:27-29 and 1:222; Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 440; A. Vanhoye, art. "Charism," in *Dictionary of Fundamental Theology*, English-Language Edition, edited by R. Latourelle & R. Fisichella (New York: The Crossroad Publishing Company, 1994) 103-108 at 104 no. 1. For the complicated relationship between the Hebraic backgrounds (*chanan*, *hesed*, *emet*), their re-interpretation through Hellenistic *charis* and the word *charis* as a "polyvalent symbol" in the NT, see S.J. Duffy, *The Dynamics of Grace: Perspectives in Theological Anthropology*. New Theology Studies 3 (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1993) 17-40; see also E. Yarnold, *The Second Gift: A Study of Grace* (Slough: St Paul Publications, 1974) 1-16.
- ⁶ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:30-116 and 1:222-223.
- ⁷ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:117-148 and 1:222-223.
- ⁸ See the analysis of the question if *charisma* can be a technical term in Paul's letters, in Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 454-459. This analysis is not so univocal as the Baumert's one, but it still reaches the same conclusion: "The very diversity of viewpoints demonstrates that for Paul, *charisma* does not have a precise technical meaning, and that no fixed concept of charism is to be found in these texts" (p. 459, see also p. 464). It even affirmatively refers to Baumert: "N. Baumert has recently published a careful analysis of all the uses of the word *charisma* in the New Testament, and he comes to the conclusion that this word never has a technical meaning by itself. In every case, it could be given its general sense of 'free gift' (*Geschenke, Gabe*)" (p. 456). This is a reference to Baumert's earlier work: N. Baumert, "Charisma und Amt bei Paulus," *L'Apotre Paul. Personnalité, style at conception du ministère*, BETL 73, edited by A. Vanhoye (Leuven, 1986) 203-228. See the same results in Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 104 no. 2.
- ⁹ Beside the detailed Baumert's analysis of each text (Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:30-116), see also Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 459-462, with the same results. Although St Thomas quotes 1 Cor 12:7 in support of such a definition ("*Unicuique autem datur manifestatio Spiritus ad utilitatem*," which he interprets by adding: "*scilicet aliorum*"; STh I/II, q. 111, a. 1) and although this passage is usually translated as "for the common good" (RSV), the original Greek expression "*pros to sympheron*" used by Paul "does not in fact say this much: it simply speaks of usefulness, without any indication of whether this usefulness is to the individual or the community." "This means that in Paul's mind, there is no necessary link between *charisma* and *diakonia*. A *diakonia* (service or ministry) is always directly oriented to the good of others, whereas this is not always the case with a *charisma*." Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 460 (see footnote n. 77 on the Catechism). This view is in contrary to Käsemann, who confuses *charisma* and *diakonia* stating that *charisma* "describes ... the essence and scope of every ecclesiastical ministry and function" (see footnotes nn. 42, 43 and 44 with the relevant text). See also Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 105 no. 3.
- ¹⁰ Vanhoye, "The Biblical Question of 'Charisms,'" 462. "Far from putting charisms on one side and positions of authority on the other, Paul declares in the same breath that within the Church God has set up a hierarchy of offices and multiple gifts (1 Cor 12:28). Instead of expressing some opposition between inspiration and institution,

- whenever the occasion arises, he describes the action of the one God, 'who inspires everything in everyone' (12:6) the presence of the one Lord (12:5), and the activity of the one Spirit (12:4, 11) ... His way of speaking with authority to those who possess charisms shows very clearly that he does not view charisms as gifts of the Spirit that grant the right to some autonomous ministry in the Church. There is no serious basis for crediting the apostle Paul with the idea of a purely charismatic community, and a great many exegetes have recognized this." Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of 'Charisms'," 462-463 (quoting H. Conzelmann and E. Cothenet and, among others scriptural references, referring to 1 Cor 14:37). See also the same results in Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 106 no. 6.
- ¹¹ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:149-184 and 1:223-224; Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of 'Charisms'," 441 and 465 n. 3; Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 104 no. 2.
- ¹² The word *charisma* is still used for the gift of the Holy Spirit itself, the gifts of creation, the sacraments, the remission of sins, virtues, everyday expressions of God's love, chastity, alms giving etc.).
- ¹³ Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:224; Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of 'Charisms'," 441; Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 104-105 no. 3.
- ¹⁴ In Rom 1:11; 5:16; 6:23; 1 Cor 1:7; 12:4, 9, 28, 30; 1 Tim 4:14; 2 Tim 1:6; 1 Pet 4:10.
- ¹⁵ In Rom 5:15a; 11:29; 1 Cor 7:7.
- ¹⁶ In Rom 12:6; 2 Cor 1:11.
- ¹⁷ 1 Cor 12:31: "*aemulamini autem charismata meliora.*"
- ¹⁸ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:185-193.
- ¹⁹ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:193-203 and 1:225; Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 105 no. 3. For Thomas' understanding of grace and his terminology, see, for example, Duffy, *The Dynamic of Grace*, 128, 130, 141, 152, 161-162, or G. Greshake, *Geschenkte Freiheit: Einführung in die Gnadenlehre*. Theologisches Seminar (Freiburg: Herder, 1977) 56-72.
- ²⁰ I.e., granted gratis, not for one's own salvation necessary, always individually given capability for service oriented towards the salvation of the other, thus distinct from "*gratia gratum faciens*," by which somebody is united to God.
- ²¹ Although the identification of *gratiae gratis datae* with *charisms* is a result of the developments in the 17th century only, this identification ascribed back to Thomas became quite usual; see Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of 'Charisms'," 441 and 466 n. 5 and Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:199-200 with n. 18 and 20 (on the confusing usage in the works of von Balthasar). Baumert comments: "*Was bei den Vätern nur ansatzweise zu beobachten war, aber von Th. nirgends aufgegriffen wird, ist heute, im 20. Jahrhundert, zum festen Bestandteil des Begriffes geworden. Dementsprechend ist auch die 'Geschichte der christlichen Charismatik' neu zu schreiben, um die Differenz zwischen der heutigen Terminologie und der der Quellen nicht zu verwischen. Dann kommt endlich Klarheit in die Frage nach dem Verhältnis von Amt und Charisma' und ist die These, daß, das kirchliche Amt das Charisma ersetzt und verdrängt, teils sich einordnet, teils neben sich zu regeln beginnt, erheblich zu revidieren.*" Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:200; see also Vanhoye, art. "Charism," 105 no. 3.
- ²² See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:203-205 and 1:225. For the background of the grace-terminology of the Council of Trent, see Duffy, *The Dynamic of Grace*, 233-236; or Greshake, *Geschenkte Freiheit*, 73-80.
- ²³ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:205-208 and 1:226.
- ²⁴ Such as the gift of praying in tongues, virginity or martyrdom.
- ²⁵ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:208-212.
- ²⁶ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:212 and 1:226-227.
- ²⁷ Already Neander (1832); see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:210-211 and 1:227.
- ²⁸ Max Weber; see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:213 and 1:227.
- ²⁹ For the developments in Catholic ecclesiology before *Mystici corporis*, see Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 127-129. *Mystici corporis* is quoted according to its English translation in Pius XII, *Mystici Corporis Christi: Encyclical Letter*, 29th June 1943, *The Holy See* (http://www.vatican.va/holy_father/pius_xii/encyclicals/documents/hf_p-xii_enc_29061943_mystici-corporis-christi_en.html).
- ³⁰ See the inclusive expressions such as "*res charismatum Paracleti*" in No. 31, translated as "gifts," and "*fons gratiarum, donorum ac charismatum omnium*" in No. 63, although in the available English version it is translated as "miraculous power."
- ³¹ See "*virtutes, dona, charismata*" in No. 48 and 77, and "*dona at charismata*" in No. 66; in the latter case put besides "sacraments, "the faith," "sacred laws," and "evangelical counsels," and in all three cases translated as "extraordinary graces."
- ³² No. 17, "*ex charismaticis*," in the original text in inverted commas, translated as "those who enjoy charismatic gifts" and later specified as "*donis prodigialibus instructi*," i.e. "gifted with miraculous powers."
- ³³ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215. For a more detailed overview of the developments among protestants, see Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 125-127.
- ³⁴ As quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215.
- ³⁵ For a detailed critique of Grau's methodology and for the consequences of his approach, see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:17-24.
- ³⁶ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215; also Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 130.
- ³⁷ See also footnotes nn. 85 and 86.
- ³⁸ For a detailed elaboration of Rahner's understanding of grace as an important background for his understanding of charisms, see, for example, Duffy, *The Dynamic of Grace*, 283-326; K. Rahner, „Grace," in *Encyclopedia of Theology: A Concise Sacramentum Mundi*, edited by K. Rahner (London: Burns & Oates, 1975) 584-598; K. Rahner, "Reflections on the Experience of Grace," in *Theological Investigations III*, 86-91.

³⁹ All quotations in this paragraph as quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215.

⁴⁰ As quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215. This concept is similarly expressed in the following quotation: “The actual fulfilment of the promise of indestructibility made to the Church and its ministries is due in part to the charisms continually given to it. But non-institutional charisms are essential alongside ‘official’ charisms, since the holy Church ... is not composed of its ministers only, but is the ‘holy people of God.’” K. Rahner, art. „Charism,” in *Encyclopedia of Theology: A Concise Sacramentum Mundi*, edited by K. Rahner (London: Burns & Oates, 1975) 184-186 at 184-185. The co-essentiality of the institutional and the charismatic dimensions is clearly expressed in another Rahner’s quotation: “On the one hand, there is office in the Church as permanent (permanent in principle) commission, originating with Christ..., unambiguously discernible in the dimension of the historical and the juridical... But on the other hand there are, in the Church of God, influences of God’s Spirit on individual faithful which are neither subject to constraint on the part of human beings nor foreseeable and ‘administrable’ by official organs, nor yet attainable via the positing of sacraments alone – and yet which make their appearance in the Church in the widest variety of forms and degrees of intensity. Inasmuch as the abiding existence of a hierarchy of divine institution, endowed with instances of authority..., and inasmuch as it can surely be regarded as the unequivocal and altogether certain teaching of the ordinary magisterium of the Church that there are effects of grace, not only *in* the Church (for the salvation of the individual) but also *for* the Church, which are not identical with these instances of authority of office and their exercise – therefore the fact of this distinction is not open to doubt. But then, inasmuch as both of these elements are among the constitutive elements of the Church, a practical theology ... may not conduct itself as if its task were restricted to directives for the proper conduct of office alone.” K. Rahner, “Office and Free Charism,” in *The Practice of Faith: A Handbook of Contemporary Spirituality*, edited by K. Lehman & A. Raffelt (London: SCM Press, 1985) 172-178 at 174. Finally, the following Baumert’s comment contains not only a further expression of the „co-essentiality“ of the charismatic and institutional dimensions, but also of the connection and fluidity between charisms and virtues: “So wenn Rahner, 1028, sagt daß sich die Charismen nur ‘teilweise’ von den christlichen Tugenden unterscheiden... und in diesem Zusammenhang darauf hinweist, daß ‘ja auch die Sakramente nur heiligend wirksam werden können durch disponierende außersakramentale Gnade Gottes (DS 1526-1529; 1559) und auch der sakramental Gerechtfertigte außersakramentaler Gnade, u.U. in einem außergewöhnlichen Maße bedarf (DS 241),’ und dann fortfährt: ‘Somit gehört das Charismatische ebenso notwendig und dauernd zum Wesen der Kirche wie das Amt und die Sakramente,’ – das heißt gewiß nicht, daß das alle derartigen hinzukommenden Gnaden ‘Charismen’ seien, wohl aber, daß das Adjektiv *de facto* weiter greift als das Substantiv: sie alle lassen sich als ‘charismatisches’ Wirken des Geistes bezeichnen.” Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:250 n. 56.

⁴¹ As quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:215.

⁴² In 1949, Käsemann wrote a paper “Amt und Gemeinde in Neuen Testament,” but it was not published until 1960. See Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 466 n. 8 and Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:216.

⁴³ Käsemann quoted in Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 466 n. 9: “While there is no real equivalent in the New Testament for our present-day conception of ‘office,’ there is a concept in Pauline and sub-Pauline theology which describes in a theologically exact and comprehensive way the essence and scope of every ecclesiastical ministry and function – namely, the concept of charisma.” Vanhoye comments: “The phrase cited indicates an opposition between the present notion of institutional ministry (‘office’) – a notion that in Käsemann’s opinion does not exist in the New Testament – and the presumably noninstitutionalized ministries (or services) and functions, the essence and scope of which are expressed in the New Testament by the term *charisma*.” Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 466 n. 9.

⁴⁴ Vanhoye concludes his analysis of “Käsemann’s inconsistency (see Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 446-451) in the following way: “Käsemann concludes his article with a significant question: ‘Why has Protestantism itself ... never made a serious attempt to create a Church order which reflected the Pauline doctrine of charismata,’ an order in which ‘all responsibility and every kind of ministry in the community would be grounded on baptism,’ by proclaiming and exercising ‘the common priesthood of all believers’ (p. 93)? This question clearly shows Käsemann’s underlying intention, which is that of setting charism and institution – with the exception of baptism – in opposition as two incompatible factors, in the dream of a purely ‘charismatic’ Church.” Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 450-451; see also Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 106 no. 6.

⁴⁵ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:217 with n. 54 and 55; Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:228 as a summary. For detailed description of the growing awareness of the importance of charisms during the Council and the most important discussions about the various versions of the final conciliar documents, see Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 130-140.

⁴⁶ LG 4, 7, 12, 15, 25, 30; DV 8; AA 3, 30; AG 4; 23; 28; PO 4; 9. These occurrences are not direct quotations from the New Testament, but parts of the explanations given by the Council; Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 442. See as well the use of other expressions for naming the same concept in LG 53; 63; PC 8; and PO 16; see also Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 105 no. 4.

⁴⁷ On the one hand, a smaller group, lead by Cardinal Rufini, promoted the traditional understanding of charisms as extraordinary, miraculous gifts. The majority, led by Cardinal Suenens, saw them in a much broader way, as gifts of grace of all types oriented to building up the Church. See Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 442-442; Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 105-106 no. 5.

⁴⁸ Thus excluding of this concept other activities of the same Spirit, such as sacraments, offices and virtues.

⁴⁹ For more detailed explanation see Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’,“ 443-446.

- ⁵⁰ See Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 139-140 and 158 n. 100 and n. 104: “In his commentary on chapter 6 of *Lumen gentium*, F. Wulf describes the theological essence of religious life as an inalienable part of the Church’s ‘charismatic structure.’”
- ⁵¹ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:228. Mullins summarises his explorations in the following way: “The Holy Spirit sanctifies, leads and enriches with virtues the People of God not only through the sacraments and the ministries of the Church, but he also distributes special gifts or charisms among the faithful of every order. Charisms can be either of a remarkable nature or more simple and widely diffused. Although the charisms are not, as such, the fruit of any of the sacraments or of ministry in the Church, and are distributed by the Spirit as he wishes, some charisms appear to be uniquely associated with particular groups in the Church. The charism of conjugal chastity, for example, is given only to those who are married and the members of the hierarchy receive a special charism of infallibility. Religious Life and consecrated celibacy are charisms (‘special graces’). Certain people also receive the charism of a missionary vocation and this charism has also been the origin of various missionary institutes in the Church. All charisms make those who receive them fit and ready for undertaking various works or offices for the renewal and further advantageous building up of the Church. The judgment of the genuineness and the ordered exercise of charisms belongs to those who preside in the Church who should, however, take care lest they extinguish the Spirit.” Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 140.
- ⁵² According to Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 467 n. 15 and 17, Küng, in his article H. Küng, “The Charismatic Structure of the Church,” *Concilium* 1 (1965) 23-33 at 33 n. 7, presents Käsemann’s article as “the most penetrating study of the biblical data” of the Pauline theology of charisms. Vanhoye even states: “Küng cites Käsemann’s article a number of times. In doing so, he expresses reservations, stating that he cannot ‘agree with his conclusions,’ although he does in fact adopt many of Käsemann’s positions and often reproduces sentences from ‘Ministry and Community’ word for word without bothering to place them in quotes; the unwary reader will think that these sentences come from the pen of H. Küng, whereas they in fact belong to E. Käsemann ... Thus, on his own account, and without giving any reference or inserting quotation marks, he takes up Käsemann’s statement that the concept of charism ‘exactly describes the essence of all ecclesial services and functions.’ Further on, he draws on Käsemann to define charism thanks to a mixture of charism, vocation, and ministry. In order to justify this mixture, Küng is satisfied with the arguments provided by Käsemann – and we have already noted the inadequacy of these.” Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 451-452.
- ⁵³ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:216-217, Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 451-454 and Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 142-143.
- ⁵⁴ Including marriage and celibacy, slavery and freedom, even drinking and eating, everything done “in the Lord.”
- ⁵⁵ See Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 452. The full quotation expressing the explored meaning is the following: “The charisms are not primarily extraordinary but common; they are not of one kind, but manifold; they are not limited to a special group of persons, but are truly universal in the Church. All this implies also that they are not a thing of the past (possible and real only in the early Church), but eminently contemporary and actual; they do not hover on the periphery of the Church but are eminently central and essential to it. In this sense one should speak of *charismatic structure of the Church* which embraces and goes beyond the structure of its government.” Quoted in Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 142.
- ⁵⁶ As quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:216.
- ⁵⁷ Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 452-453; see also Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 106 no. 6.
- ⁵⁸ “This interpretation is confirmed by the fact that in his article, Küng refrains from citing the conciliar phrase indicating the role of pastors in the discernment of charisms and their properly ordered use” by leaving the role of maintaining unity in the Church in all its variety “to the same Spirit who creates this unity and this order.” Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 453. Vanhoye then shows persuasively, that “in the apostle Paul’s long discussion on the spiritual gifts and the charisms (1 Cor 12 – 14), he is certainly not satisfied with the fundamental answer given by Küng. Paul adds another, which is not in contradiction with the first, but that he considers is also necessary: that of apostolic authority.” Vanhoye, „The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms,’” 454. Baumert directs his critique of Küng’s position in similar direction, see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:238 n. 38.
- ⁵⁹ Mullins, commenting on Boff’s book *Church, Charism and Power: Liberation Theology and the Institutional Church* (London: SCM, 1985), states: “Like Hasenüttl, L. Boff’s approach tends to see the Church as essentially charismatic rather than hierarchical. In his writings, the hierarchical nature of the Church recedes into the background to such an extent that he seems to have more in common with the position of Sohm and Käsemann than with that of Vatican II.” Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 143. More detailed analysis of Boff’s positions, based on Boff’s *EcclesioGenesis: The Base Communities Reinvent the Church* (Maryknoll: Orbis Books, 1986; Portuguese original in 1977, resp. 1981), offers J. Dupuis, “Lay People in Church and World,” *Gregorianum* 66 (1987) 347-390 at 369-373; his conclusion is a little bit friendlier than Mullins’ one, but pointing in the same direction: “It would be a misrepresentation of Boff’s position to interpret him as referring the founding of the Church only to the action of the Spirit who after Easter inspired the apostolic community. Boff intends to combine in the institution of the Church both the Christological and pneumatological principles. But is the Christological principle accounted for adequately? It is not enough to refer to the presence of the Risen Lord to, and his action upon, the community of the apostles; due weight must also be given, even though with the caution prompted by sound exegesis, to the action of the historical Jesus during his earthly mission. This is where Boff’s treatment seems inadequate, especially where the institution of the ‘Twelve’ by Jesus is concerned... In Congar’s

- felicitous formulation, the Son Incarnate and the Spirit 'co-institute' the Church; or in the words of another author, while Jesus 'instituted' the Church, she is 'co-instituted' by the Spirit." Dupuis, 372-373.
- ⁶⁰ It seems to me, that this is the case, for example, of W.J. Rademacher, *Lay Ministry: A Theological, Spiritual, & Pastoral Handbook* (Slough: St Paul Publications, 1991).
- ⁶¹ See T.F. O'Meara, *Theology of Ministry*, Completely Revised Edition (New York: Paulist Press, 1999). In this influential and in many respect very important and balanced book, O'Meara seems to understand Paul's usage of *charisma* as a technical theological term which was given "a new, theological nuance and richness" by Paul (p. 53). The usage of *charisma* in Rom 6:23 is for O'Meara an opportunity to introduce a new term "primal charism, the source of all other charisms" (p. 54). In his reflections on the "Sources of Ministry" (pp. 199-224), while criticizing some protestant positions which "pit pneumatic power against community" and are "overly intent on finding at the origin of Christianity an opposition between liberty and order, between personality and grace" (p. 202), he follows Küng's terminologically confusing understanding of charisms and the "charismatic structure of the church" in order "to avoid continuing a dichotomy between the baptismal life and episcopal ordination" (p. 204). While his understanding of "charism" and 'service' as normal aspects of community life" and his emphasis that "every ministry is grounded in charisms; some charisms in individual Christians lead to ministry" (p. 206) can be seen as acceptable, it would be still necessary to explore more in detail O'Meara's understanding of this "grounding of ministry in charism" and of "ordination" as "a symbolic event, a liturgical, public commissioning that points to some deeper, more stable reality" or as "the liturgical and communal bridge between personal charism and particular ministry" (p. 220). Although all of these concepts can be understood as being in accord with the conciliar teaching on the distinctive complementarity of "hierarchical and charismatic gifts," O'Meara's terminology of charisms is, in my opinion, still confusing (in addition to the unclear terminology in regard to Paul's usage of "*charisma*", he wrongly identifies Thomas' "*gratia gratis data*" with the term "charism," p. 203; see our footnote n. 21) and his concept of ministry can be easily misunderstood.
- ⁶² See Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 148. This new search for a new integration can be partly seen as a reaction to some not helpful developments as summarised above, but also promoted by newly emerging exegetical consensus. However, it can be important to see these developments as well on the background of the process of maturing of theologies of the laity, secularity and liberation with their search for deeper integration of the "Church" and the "world" and overcoming excessive individualism and subjectivism by developing, for example, the notions of "social grace" and the practice of "basic ecclesial communities." See, for example, G. Magnani, "Does the So-Called Theology of the Laity Possess a Theological Status?" in *Vatican II Assessment and Perspectives: Twenty-five Years After (1962-1987)*, 3 vols., edited by R. Latourelle (New York: Paulist Press, 1988) 1:568-633; R. Latourelle, "Church III: Motive of Credibility," in *Dictionary of Fundamental Theology*, English-Language Edition, edited by R. Latourelle & R. Fisichella (New York: The Crossroad Publishing Company, 1994) 154-170; Lefebvre, S., "Secularity," in *Dictionary of Fundamental Theology*, 976-986; Duffy, *The Dynamic of Grace*, 344-370.
- ⁶³ In this context, Mullins (Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 147) refers for example to G. Rambaldi (1975), who, based on LG 4, LG 12 and AA 3, emphasizes that "the Holy Spirit confers graces on Christians to stimulate and enable them to contribute to the life and mission of the Church both through the sacraments and hierarchical ministries and through the charisms. This means that the various charisms need to be exercised in authentic and sincere communion with the other members of the People of God. An authentic charism is an invitation and a capacity to work in the Church for the sake of the life and the apostolate of the Church and by no means should it be understood as loosening the bond with, or freeing a person from, the Body of Christ." Then he states: "Rambaldi's approach is faithful to the teaching of Vatican II and, at least in the opinion of this writer, it provides a fruitful avenue of approach to the many difficult issues relating to charisms in the present day Church. The tension between the charismatic and hierarchical aspects of the Church is not something new or unique to our times but is rather part of its very nature... one of the functions of the hierarchy is to ensure that this tension remains fruitful." Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms," 147 (see also further elaboration of this interdependence on the following page).
- ⁶⁴ See, for example, H. Conzelmann, *TWNT*, 9:396; for Rahner's position, see the quotations in footnote n. 40. Congar's emphasis on the role of the Holy Spirit in all the sacraments, on the Holy Spirit as the "co-founder" of the Church, on the complementarity of the "two missions" of Christ and of the Spirit, and the Spirit's role in all of the four traditional "marks" of the Church, all in Y. Congar, *Der Hilige Geist*, translated by A. Berz (Leipzig: St. Benno-Verlag, 1988) Zweites Buch, Erster Teil and Dittes Buch, Zweiter Teil; French original: *Je crois en l'Esprit Saint*, 3 vols. (Paris: Les Editions du Cerf, 1979-1980), for a friendly critique of Congar's original positions see A. Dulles, *A Church to Believe In: Discipleship and the Dynamics of Freedom* (New York: Crossroad, 1982) 26-27; besides this critique of Congar (as well as of von Balthasar, Rahner and Küng), Dulles offers very important synthesis of "unity in distinctiveness" of charism and institution (pp. 29-36); for the newer exegetical position in the question of the presence of the "apostolicity dimension" (later called hierarchical) from the very beginning of the Church, see, for example, F.A. Sullivan, *The Church We Believe In* (Mahwah: Paulist Press, 1988) 153-168, and M. Kehl, *Die Kirche: Eine katholische Ekklesiologie* (Würzburg: Echter Verlag, 2001) 306-319; the Kehl's concept of the Church as "*communio hierarchica*" (pp. 104-105), his understanding of "*das Institutionelle als Zeichen des identifizierenden Geistes*," "*das Institutionelle als Zeichen des integrierenden Geistes*," and "*das Institutionelle als Zeichen des befreienden Geistes*" (pp. 392-402) and his "*Prinzip der Gleichursprünglichkeit*" of unity and diversity (e.g. pp. 75, 78f, 280, 374) in Kehl, *Die Kirche*, the Ratzinger's understanding of "the two inseparable components of the sacraments": "first, the incarnational-christological element, that is, the Church's being bound to the 'once only' of the incarnation and the Easter events, the link to God's history; second, and simultaneously, the making present of this event in the power of the

- Holy Spirit, hence, the christological-pneumatological component, which guarantees at once the novelty and continuity of the living Church” in Ratzinger, “The Theological Locus,” 499; see Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 106-107 no. 6 and 7.
- ⁶⁵ “... at the Council, the ‘charismatic’ and ‘pneumatic’ aspects of the Church gradually came to be recognized as formally co-constitutive of the Church’s mystery... In the quarter century or so since the Council, we have seen the emergence of an at least official recognition that, alongside the hierarchical structure instituted by Christ which distinguishes clerics from non-clerics, the People of God may be distinguished one from another also in terms of the charisms which they have received from the Holy Spirit.” Mullins, “The Theology of Charisms,” 123-124.
- ⁶⁶ Using the word “charism” in its different meanings (the scriptural one and the today’s theological one) in the expression “the charismatic constitutive structure of the Church” has very confusing consequences. If this expression has to say that charisms in today’s sense are a (indispensable) essential element of the Church (which they are), the expression “constitutive structure” points perhaps too high; if it should say that all structural elements of the Church are “God’s gifts” (which they are), then the word “charismatic” is used in its Pauline meaning, thus in a confusing and inappropriate way; but if the expression should say that the whole structure of the Church is exclusively carried by (or based on) immediate dynamic activities of the Spirit and not also by historically, from Christus permanently constitute elements, then it is incompatible not only with the Catholic understanding of the Church, but also with the newly generally (as well ecumenically) accepted understanding of the NT texts. See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:237; for the ecumenical agreement in this point, see, for example, the *Lima Document* (quoted in Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:219 and 1:238).
- ⁶⁷ Baumert, after having listed a whole range of postconciliar “definitions” of the term “charisma” by various authors (see Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:9-15, 1:218-219), he concludes: “*Die Exegeten haben immer noch die Tendenz, in den paulinischen Charismenbegriff mehr hineinzu legen, als das Wort bei Paulus bedeutet; Systematiker und Dogmatiker hingegen denken von Sachfragen her und machen sich kaum bewußt, daß ihre Aussagen noch weiter über Paulus hinausgehen. Die Option des II. Vatikanums aber wird, da man Paulus hinter sich zu haben meint, kaum eingehalten. Die Verwirrung ist eher noch gewachsen.*” Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:219-220.
- ⁶⁸ See, for example, the article on Charisms by A. George & P. Grelot, “Charisms,” in *Dictionary of Biblical Theology*, Second Edition, edited under the direction of X.L. Dufour, translated under the direction of J. Cahill, London: Geoffrey Chapman, 1982 (first published in English 1967); 68-71 at 69 is a typical example of the confusions in terms seeing a (partly) technical use of the word *charisma* already in the NT. Although the article on Charisms in *The New Dictionary of Catholic Spirituality* is more careful in dealing with the question of the biblical meaning of *charisma*, it still confuses its broad scriptural meaning with its changed technical meaning in today’s theology; E.J. Malatesta, “Charism,” in *The New Dictionary of Catholic Spirituality*, edited by M. Downey (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1993) 140-143 at 142.
- ⁶⁹ See No. 24.
- ⁷⁰ See, first of all, No. 798, but also No. 688, 799-801, 951, and 2003.
- ⁷¹ See for example No. 490, 791, 798, 809, 814, 864, 913, 919, 924, 951, 1094, 1461, 1641, 1788, 1937, 2003, 2004, 2014, 2024, 2690, and 2740.
- ⁷² The word “*charisma*” (in the later issued official Latin version) or its derivatives is used nineteen times: No. 94, 688, 798-801, 809, 890, 910, 951, 1175, 1508, 2003, 2024, 2035, and 2684.
- ⁷³ In No. 2003, the Catechism states: “There are sacramental graces, gifts proper to the different sacraments. There are furthermore special graces, also called charisms after the Greek term used by St. Paul and meaning ‘favor’, ‘gratuitous gift’, ‘benefit.’” *Catechism of the Catholic Church*, Library of Classic Texts “...at your fingertips,” Student’s Reference Library on CD-ROM edited by Patrick Rogers, 2002. This inconsistency is obvious also in the fact that on the other hand, the Greek *charismata* from Rom 11:39 is here properly translated as “gifts” (No. 839).
- ⁷⁴ The following observations are based on Mullins, “The Theology of Charisms,” 149-152.
- ⁷⁵ For the confusing usage of the terminology in regard to the original and technical meaning of “charism,” see the pervious paragraph with n. 73. The Catechism does not elaborate the distinction between actual and habitual graces nor the relationship between sacramental and sanctifying grace. Traditionally, charisms have been seen as “actual graces.” See Mullins, “The Theology of Charisms,” 150.
- ⁷⁶ No. 2004, for religious life as a “charism” see also No. 1175, 924, 919, and 2684.
- ⁷⁷ Which corresponds to the gift of tongues as a gift for deepening personal prayer, in No. 2003 included under the concept of charisms, besides the fact that all charisms are “oriented toward sanctifying grace” (No. 2003). See footnote n. 9 on the biblical foundation of this position. For detailed discussion (including the discussion on the distinction between “*gratia gratum faciens*” and “*gratiae gratis datae*”) see Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 103-108 or (for a short summary) D.L. Schindler, “Institution and Charism: The Missions of the Son and the Spirit in Church and World,” *Communio* 25 (1998) 253-273 at 254 n. 3. Rahner’s position, as commented by Baumert, would correspond to this openness of the term: “So wenn Rahner ... sagt daß sich die Charismen nur ‘teilweise’ von den christlichen Tugenden unterscheiden... und in diesem Zusammenhang darauf hinweist, daß ja auch die Sakramente nur heiligend wirksam werden können durch disponierende außersakramentale Gnade Gottes (DS 1526-1529; 1559) und auch der sakramental Gerechtfertigte außersakramentaler Gnade, u.U. in einem außergewöhnlichen Maße bedarf (DS 241), und dann fortfährt: ‘Somit gehört das Charismatische ebenso notwendig und dauernd zum Wesen der Kirche wie das Amt und die Sakramente,’ – das heißt gewiß nicht, daß das alle derartigen hinzukommenden Gnaden ‘Charismen’ seien, wohl aber, daß das Adjektiv de facto weiter greift als das Substantiv: sie alle lassen sich als ‘charismatisches’ Wirken des Geistes bezeichnen.” Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:250 n. 56.

- ⁷⁸ In regard to ordination, Mullins refers to No. 891-892 and the “charism” of infallibility; in regard to matrimony, he refers to No. 1641 that quotes the passage on “special gifts” of Christian spouses from LG 11 (with the footnote referring to 1 Cor 7:7 with the expression “*idion charisma*,” and to a Augustine’s quotation on “conjugal fidelity” as God’s gift); Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 151 and 162 nn. 161-163. In any case, the close connection between charismatic “graces of state” and “sacramental grace” can be here seen quite clearly. For detailed elaboration of the question of the relationship between “*kléisis*” and “*charisma*” and the distinctiveness of a vocation to a state of life and the state of life itself, see N. Baumert, *Frau und Mann bei Paulus: Überwindung eines Mißverständnisses* (Würzburg: Echter Verlag, 1992) 389-417; English version: N. Baumert, *Woman and Man in Paul: Overcoming a Misunderstanding*, translated by N. Baumert, P. Madigan & L.M. Maloney (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1996). Mullins concludes that “the Catechism does not refer to *grace of state* charisms associated with any of the other five sacraments but, in principle at least, the existence of such charisms is not ruled out.” Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 151. In the last footnote (p. 162 n. 163), commenting on Grillmeier’s view of all charisms as being given sacramentally, and specifically through the sacrament of confirmation, he concludes: “While Vatican II and the new Catechism reject such a view (see also the address of the bishop given in the new rite of confirmation), they do not necessarily reject the notion that certain charisms may be proper to the state of the confirmed.”
- ⁷⁹ See Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 146, quoting *Evangelica testificatio* (1971; speaking about “the charism of Religious Life), *Mutuae relations* (1978; referring to the “‘charismatic nature’ of the consecrated life),” and Bruno Secondin (describing the consecrated life as a “permanent charismatic state”). See also the Catechism of the Catholic Church, No. 1175, 919, 924, and 2684. “The religious vocation and life is thus essentially charismatic and prophetic both in origin and mode of operation.” M.C. Adams, art. “Religious Life,” in *The New Dictionary of Catholic Spirituality*, edited by M. Downey (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1993) 817-822 at 819; see also Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” 107 no. 7.
- ⁸⁰ Mullins, „The Theology of Charisms,” 124.
- ⁸¹ Ch. 5 and 6 of *Lumen gentium* and *Perfectae caritatis*. For theological and exegetical background, see, for example Baumert, *Frau und Mann*, 385-388 and M.C. Adams, art. “Religious Life,” in *The New Dictionary of Catholic Spirituality*, edited by M. Downey (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1993) 817-822.
- ⁸² In our context of exploring the area of the term “charisma,” the most important movement where a renewal of the charismatic dimension in practice was felt immediately after the Council, is the Charismatic Renewal. While some of the authors coming from this background used quite confusing definition of the word “charism” (see, for example, A. Bittlinger, H. Mühlen or F. Kuntner speaking about charism as a “natural endowment in the service of the Spirit,” or Laurentin’s (miss)understanding of charism as “gifts through which the Spirit structures the Church,” others used Charismatic Renewal for deeper understanding the charismatic phenomena in the Church in a more balanced way. See, for example, Congar, *Der Hilfige Geist*, Zweites Buch, Dritter Teil, 264-308; N. Baumert, *Gaben des Geistes Jesu: Das Charismatische in der Kirche* (Graz: Styria, 1986) 11-62; F.A. Sullivan, *Charisms and Charismatic Renewal* (Ann Arbor, 1982); see also Sullivan, *The Church*, 94 and Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:234. However, later on, it became clear, that all the ecclesial movements (e.g. Focolare, Neocatechumenat, Cursillo, Schönstatt, Communione a liberatione etc.) or new communities (e.g. Beatitudes, Chemin Neuf, Emmanuel, Sant Egidio etc.) should be seen as an expression of the charismatic dimension of the Church (without being blind to the complex problematic of the criteria of their “ecclesial character,” see, for example, *Redemptoris missio* No. 72 and *Christifideles laici* No. 30). For more information see, for example, B. Secondin, *Nová hnutí v církvi* [Movements, Associations and Groups in the Church], translated by J. Plhoň (Karmelitánské nakladatelství: Kostelní Vydří, 1999); the original: B. Secondin, *Movimenti, associazioni, gruppi nella Chiesa* (Roma: Edizioni Paoline, 1991).
- ⁸³ A very good example of this encounter (which is, of course, enriching for both ‘sides’) can be seen in the article by A.M. Sicari, “Ecclesial Movements: A New Framework for Ancient Charisms,” *Communio* 29 (2002) 286-308. The author define the charism (understood in the context of vocation to consecrated life or within a ecclesial movement) in the following way: “The charism is a gift whereby the Spirit *marks certain of the baptized*, makes them fall in love with Christ *in a special way*, *gathers* them in a spiritual homeland, assigns them particular tasks for the building up of the Church, and educates them with the *pedagogical persuasiveness* that characterizes the charism.” Sicari, 293.
- ⁸⁴ Besides the article mentioned in the previous footnote, see, for example, I. Ker, *The New Movements: A Theological Introduction* (London: Catholic Truth Society, 2001); P. Coda, “The Charisms and Co-Essentiality,” A speech at Speyer ’99 Meeting, *Focolare Movement* (www.focolare.org/en/sif/1999/19990608e_d.htm); P. Coda, “The Ecclesial Movements: Gift of the Spirit for our Times,” A lecture at a Theological-Pastoral Congress 26-28 June 2001 in Castel Gandolfo, *Focolare Movement* (http://www.focolare.org/en/sif/2001/20010707e_f.htm); J. Ratzinger, “The Theological Locus of Ecclesial Movements,” *Communio* 25 (1998) 480-504.
- ⁸⁵ In his message at the opening of the World Congress of Ecclesial Movements in Rome on 27th May 1998, the pope stated (No. 5): “I have often had occasion to stress that there is no conflict or opposition in the Church between the institutional dimension and the charismatic dimension, of which movements are a significant expression. Both are co-essential to the divine constitution of the Church founded by Jesus, because they both help to make the mystery of Christ and his saving work present in the world.” John Paul II., „Holy Father’s Message the World Congress of Ecclesial Movements and New Communities,” 27th May 1998, *The Holy See* (http://www.vatican.va/roman_curia/pontifical_councils/laity/documents) No. 5. In his later speech at the same congress, he spoke (in No. 4, quoting LG 12) about the Vatican II Council, where “the Church rediscovered the charismatic dimension as one of her constitutive elements.” Then he continued: “The institutional and charismatic

- aspects are co-essential as it were [Italian original (?) reads: ‘*quasi co-essenzial*’] to the Church’s constitution. They contribute, although differently, to the life, renewal and sanctification of God’s People. It is from this providential rediscovery of the Church’s charismatic dimension that, before and after the Council, a remarkable pattern of growth has been established for ecclesial movements and new communities.” John Paul II., „Holy Father’s Speech for the World Congress of Ecclesial Movements and New Communities“ 30th May 1998, *The Holy See* (http://www.vatican.va/roman_curia/pontifical_councils/laity/documents) No. 4.
- ⁸⁶ For example, Coda, “Ecclesial Movements,” towards the end, and “The Charisms and Co-Essentiality,” towards the end, or Ker, *The New Movements*, 17-19. From the two articles by Piero Coda I have read (see footnote n. 84), it seems that he understands the so-called “Petrine dimension” as the hierarchical one, the “Johannine dimension” as the charismatic one, and the “Marian dimension” as the deepest level of origin, from which both of the dimensions come out. However, if John should represent simultaneously both the charismatic dimension and love, the charismatic dimension would have to be seen broader than only in the today’s technical meaning of „charisms.“ Ker is in his explanations not more helpful. To confuse the things even further, Schindler connect the charismatic dimension not with John, but with Maria; see D.L. Schindler, “Institution and Charism: The Missions of the Son and the Spirit in Church and World,” *Communio* 25 (1998) 253-273 at 265.
- ⁸⁷ See Coda, “The Charisms and Co-Essentiality,” par. 6-8; in Coda, “Theological Movements,” par. 5, we can read: “Von Balthasar comments that since the ordained ministry too is born and nurtured from a gift of the Spirit, it can be said that through the work of the Holy Spirit the whole Church is founded ‘on objective and subjective charism.’”
- ⁸⁸ It seems to me that Schindler, using the same sources and concepts of “objectivity” and “subjectivity,” was able to apply it to the theme of “charisma and institution” in a terminologically less confusing way, however in a way quite difficult to understand in its whole complexity. Schindler, “Institution and Charism,” 253-273 at 254 and 259-261.
- ⁸⁹ For example, Ratzinger, “The Theological Locus.” At the beginning he shows that the perspectives of “institution and charism,” “Christology and pneumatology,” and “hierarchy and prophecy” are not adequate (although not false in itself) for reflecting on the phenomena of ecclesial movements. In the first case, he says that the concept of “institution” is too ambiguous to be useful. In the second, he rightly points out the dangers of connecting sacraments exclusively with Christology and the incarnation on the one hand, and movements and charisms with pneumatology on the other. In the third case, he is worried of dividing the Church into a “prophetic class” and the “hierarchy.” Then he uses a historical approach and comes to the conclusion that movements in the Church (similarly to the phenomena of religious life) can be seen as expression of the need to complement the local dimension of apostolic ministry with a universal one.
- ⁹⁰ For example, Ker, *The New Movements*.
- ⁹¹ See, for example, the complex trinitarian approach of Schindler: “Our purpose is to try to indicate the ultimate theological grounds for this simultaneous unity and distinctness between institution and charismatic gift. Above all, we hope to accomplish two things: first, to show how this unity and distinction has its beginnings already in the trinitarian life and love of God, and hence is already part of the original meaning of holiness; and, secondly, to show how a proper understanding of this relation of unity coincident with distinction is indispensable both for the Church as the earthly sacrament of trinitarian holiness, and in turn for the entire order of creation itself which is called to participate in this holiness.” Schindler, “Institution and Charism,” 255. See also Coda: “The relationship between the institutional and charismatic dimensions, in the final analysis, is seen as a reflection in the life of the Church of the very life of the Holy Trinity, in which the divine Persons live in fullness One for, with, and in the Others. Immediately after having described the hierarchical and charismatic gifts, in fact, the *Lumen gentium* affirms that ‘the Church shines forth as a people made one with the unity of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit’ (LG 4).” Coda, “The Charisms and Co-Essentiality,” towards the end. See also Kehl, *Die Kirche*, 63-66 (with a detailed bibliography on p. 63 n. 1).
- ⁹² See, for example, Sullivan’s concept of the Church as the “sacrament of integral salvation” in F.A. Sullivan, *The Church We Believe In* (Mahwah: Paulist Press, 1988) 132-151 and Kehl’s concept of the Church as “das ‚Sakrament der Communio Gottes‘; als solches bildet sie die vom Hl. Geist geeinte, dem Sohn Jesus Christus zugestaltete und mit der ganzen Schöpfung zum Reich Gottes des Vaters berufene Gemeinschaft der Glaubenden, die synodal und ‚hierarchisch‘ zugleich verfasst ist.” Kehl, *Die Kirche*, 51 and his notions of a „kommunizierende Kirche“ which is being concretised in „kommunikative Lebensräume des Glaubens“; Kehl, *Die Kirche*, 37 and 132-159.
- ⁹³ See Duffy, *The Dynamic of Grace*, 370-385; M.J. Scanlon, “The Ecclesial Dimension of Anthropology,” in *The Gift of the Church: A Textbook on Ecclesiology*, edited by P.C. Phan (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 2000) 193-214.
- ⁹⁴ See A. Vanhoye, art. “Charism,” in *Dictionary of Fundamental Theology*, English-Language Edition, edited by R. Latourelle & R. Fisichella (New York: The Crossroad Publishing Company, 1994) 103-108; Kehl, *Die Kirche*, 110-111; N. Baumert, art. “Charisma,” in: *Archiv für Begriffsgeschichte*, Bd. 38, edited by G. Scholtz (Bonn, 1995) 276-278.
- ⁹⁵ See N. Baumert, *Gaben des Geistes Jesu*, 145-156; N. Baumert, „Charisma und Amt bei Paulus,“ in *L’Apôtre Paul. Personnalité, style et conception du ministère*, BethL 73, edited by A. Vanhoye (Leuven, 1986) 223-228; A. Vanhoye, “The Biblical Question of ‘Charisms’ after Vatican II,” in *Vatican II Assessment and Perspectives: Twenty-five Years After (1962-1987)*, edited by R. Latourelle (New York: Paulist Press, 1988) 1:439-468; N. Baumert, “Charisma-Versuch einer Sprachregelung,” *ThPh* 66 (1991) 21-48; N. Baumert, art. “Charisma,” in: *Archiv für Begriffsgeschichte*, Bd. 38, edited by G. Scholtz (Bonn, 1995) 276-278; and, finally, N. Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 2 vols. (Würzburg: Echter, 2001).

- ⁹⁶ The following summary is based on Baumert's most recent book Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:229-252. Here it is possible to look for a more detailed reflections on each of the questions.
- ⁹⁷ The word, the sacraments, the Church as the foundational sacrament including its ordained offices as ways of embodiment of the Spirit.
- ⁹⁸ The Holy Spirit is, of course, also the original giver of the institutional elements (see LG 4).
- ⁹⁹ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:277. See also Ratzinger's understanding of "the two inseparable components of the sacraments," "the incarnational-christological element" and "the christological-pneumatological component"; Ratzinger, "The Theological Locus," 499.
- ¹⁰⁰ See the last part of footnote n. 40.
- ¹⁰¹ It is true that, of course, God is always, in all forms of God's activities, free, never dependent on our activities. It is not possible to manipulate with God in any way. However, in some special cases, God has "bound" Godself, by God's promises, to some specific human activities (for example, the sacraments). In contrary, charisms are always given in a dynamic way, unexpectedly, freely, without any possibility to "guarantee" them.
- ¹⁰² Such a charism is sometimes called "office-charism," because it is given together with the sacramental ordination and in order to accomplish its end. For connection of charisms with further sacraments, see footnote n. 78.
- ¹⁰³ Similarly, some charisms can be in a special way connected with some other sacraments or states of life, but, again, not identical with them. Others can be concretised in a kind of more stable ministry, way of life or (new) community or movement.
- ¹⁰⁴ Such as the gift of prayer in tongues, the gift of tears, visions, celibacy and other. Of course, the Church *communio* will indirectly profit as well as from all of these more personal charisms, but therefore they do not have to be (mis)understood "pragmatically."
- ¹⁰⁵ When LG 12 says that "by these gifts he [the Spirit] makes them fit and ready to undertake various tasks and offices for the renewal and building up of the Church," it is still possible to understand the word "tasks" as well as activities oriented toward personal growth without having an explicitly "ministerial" character. In the same sense can be interpreted the new Catechism, which speaks about "special graces, also called charisms," which are "oriented toward sanctifying grace," "intended for the common good of the Church" and "at the service of charity which builds up the Church" (No. 2003). For the discussion on this topic in the contexts of the new Catechism and the Pauline texts, see footnotes nn. 77, 77 and 9 with the relevant texts.
- ¹⁰⁶ Because of this intimate interconnection between "nature" and "grace," it is clear that many of the "more simple and widely diffused" charisms will be intimately interwoven with quite natural foundations.
- ¹⁰⁷ The same about the "remarkable" charisms and their possible connections with some paranormal phenomena.
- ¹⁰⁸ We can (and should) ask, for example: Is the process marked by some of the typical characteristics of the Pentecost-Spirit? Does the person act in listening obedience towards and dependence on God or in his or her own power? Is the effect of his or her "ministry" on his or her disposal (such as in the case of a "natural healer" or "clairvoyant"), or is it more a result of his or her acceptance of God's inspirations or impulses?
- ¹⁰⁹ Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:248-251.
- ¹¹⁰ Here is, in addition, inserted: „An exception is the case of modern Greek, where the wider meaning a "present," a "gift" has been preserved besides the special term." Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:248. Although the "office" is here excluded from A)c) and as "Church commissioning, ordination etc." included (probably as one of the *gratiae gradis datae* of St Thomas) into B)b), in the second volume of Baumert's work, he does include "ordination: commissioning and empowering for a service of Church leadership" among the list of all the seven sacraments under the heading "objective salvation-goods," and, at the same time, under the heading of "subjective salvation-goods" as well (as "the offices of the Church"). Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 2:23-24.
- ¹¹¹ Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:248-249.
- ¹¹² See the second part of footnote n. 40.
- ¹¹³ Baumert inserts a comment: "I did never find this usage in any period before the 20th century."
- ¹¹⁴ See *Mystici corporis*, No. 17 (the Church is composed not only "*ex charismatibus*").
- ¹¹⁵ "Among these gifts the primacy belongs to the grace of the apostles to whose authority the Spirit himself subjects even charismatics (cf. 1 Cor. 14)." LG 7
- ¹¹⁶ Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:249-251. See the second part of footnote n. 40.
- ¹¹⁷ They are based on the concept of charisms accepted at Vatican II; they correspond to the core of the basic ecumenical consensus; they are compatible with the current exegetic understandings of the role of authority in the Scriptures; they are sensitive to a certain degree of fluidity which is necessarily present in every speaking about the mystery of God's trinitarian life and our participation in it etc.
- ¹¹⁸ See Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:272; compare with the confusion described in footnote 66.
- ¹¹⁹ Baumert, *Charisma – Taufe – Geisttaufe*, 1:28; the whole paragraph is based on Ibid., 1:27-28.
- ¹²⁰ See footnote 85. In addition to the content-based argument contained in this essay, the full "co-essentiality" is, in my opinion, confirmed by the pope's text itself. In the same number (No. 4), immediately before the sentence with the expression "*quasi co-essential*," there is a quotation from LG 12, introduced by the following sentence: "This was the unforgettable experience of the Second Vatican Ecumenical Council during which, under the guidance of the same Spirit, the Church rediscovered *the charismatic dimension as one of her constitutive elements*" (italics my). Hence, I would say, if the "charismatic dimension" is seen as "one of the constitutive elements" of the Church, than it is clear, that it have to be understood as "co-essential" (i.e. equally essential as the other constitutive element, the "institutional dimension").

- ¹²¹ In this concept, there is no place for (miss)understanding it in the sense of Käsemann's or Küng's concepts of a "*charismatische Grundstruktur*" of the Church which is prior to all other aspects. If a priority should be spoken about, than it can be perhaps expressed in the words of the *Catechism of the Catholic Church*, which reads that "the 'Marian' dimension of the Church precedes the 'Petrine'" (No. 773). However, even this could be wrongly understood, if the "Marian" dimension would mean the "charismatic" one in its today's meaning (as it was the case of my bishop at the Christmas dinner). On the other hand, if somebody spoke about the "Marian" dimension as "charismatic" in its original Scriptural meaning of the Greek word "*charisma*" ("a gracious gift of God"), then it would be theologically right, but terminologically confusing.
- ¹²² This, in my opinion, would correspond to Mullin's assessment expressed in more "conciliar" language: "At the Council, the 'charismatic' or 'pneumatic' aspects of the Church gradually came to be recognized as formally co-constitutive of the Church's mystery. A theological synthesis was also achieved by recognizing that the Church is the fruit of one and the same divine plan which is brought to effect through the missions of both the Son and the Spirit. The polarization implicit in regarding hierarchical gifts as deriving from Christ and charismatic gifts as coming from the Spirit has also been overcome through a recognition that both kinds of gifts come from Christ through the same Spirit." Mullins, "The Theology of Charisms," 123.
- ¹²³ First of all in ecclesiology, pneumatology and the theology of grace.
- ¹²⁴ For example in the area of mutuality of ordained ministry and the role of the whole community including charisms, viz. the whole complicated area of collaborative ministry. Many tensions in this area are actually caused by different concepts of the role of the charismatic and hierarchical dimensions in the Church constitution, life and ministry (for example, by extreme emphasising one or the other in order to "resolve" their necessary mutuality), but also by confused terminology.
- ¹²⁵ For example, in the area of new ecclesial movements, communities and consecrated life, but also as a possible framework interconnection between the mystical, charismatic, incarnational and ecclesial emphases in spirituality (see the next conclusion).
- ¹²⁶ I am using these labels in the sense of L. Doohan, "Church," in *The New Dictionary of Catholic Spirituality*, edited by M. Downey (Collegeville: The Liturgical Press, 1993) 164-173 at 170-172. Or, in other terminology, the "pneumatic" and the "autogenic" spirituality; in the sense of the three "models of spirituality" suggested by P. Collins, *Spirituality for the 21st Century: Christian Living in a Secular Age* (Dublin: The Columba Press, 1999) 24-36; his third model, besides the "pneumatic" one and the "autogenic" one, is called "programmatic spirituality." Here I mean the tensions between an excessive or exclusive emphasis on communion, collaboration, relationships, communal prayer, communicative liturgy and so on (as often present in some of the new ecclesial movements including most of the prayer groups of Charismatic Renewal) on the one hand, and an excessive or exclusive emphasis on secularity, social and political dimensions of Christianity, justice and peace, social engagement and so on (as often stressed in the theologies of liberation and lived out in various basic ecclesial communities and other activities) on the other.
- ¹²⁷ For example, the typically "charismatic," "evangelisation" and "ecclesial" emphasis of most of the new ecclesial movements, the "incarnational" emphasis of other, more socially and service-oriented groups, the necessary official emphasis on the "institutional" dimension (which could be connected with the third Collins' model of "programmatic spirituality" – see the previous footnote), and the renewed emphasis on the "mystical" dimension as well (this can be seen, for example, in the rapidly growing area of the ministry of spiritual direction, the interest in retreats, seminars, spirituality courses etc.).
- ¹²⁸ See the basic explanation of the charism-definition in the section 2.2, which actually contains all the necessary dimensions for the organic unity: the typically "charismatic" emphasis in "freely given, gratuitous, dynamic"; the "ecclesial" emphasis in "in the Church (in, through, or oriented towards the Body of Christ)"; the "evangelisation emphasis" in "oriented towards salvation (transforming redemption in Christ)"; the "incarnational" emphasis in "in the world (through the Church oriented to the whole unsaved 'world')"; the "institutional" emphasis in "in the communion (communication and spiritual discernment) of Christian faithful (the Church)"; the necessary interrelation between the "mystical" emphasis and the "service" emphasis in "both primarily oriented toward the conduct and grow of *one's own spiritual life*, and primarily oriented toward a salvation-service for *the benefit of the other*," etc.
- ¹²⁹ I guess that the word "*diakonia*" calls for similar approach to the complicated historical linguistic developments of its meaning as Baumert used for "*charisma*." But other terms such as "ordination," "hierarchy," "clergy," and "institution" call for further clarifications.